A Two-Sided Certified Bracket for the de Bruijn–Newman Constant of the Davenport–Heilbronn Function, and What the Heat Flow Does Not Transfer

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October 2026 — Technical Note
doi:10.5281/zenodo.XXXXXXXX

Abstract

Let $\Phi_F(x) = 4e^{3x}\sum_{n\geq 1} n a_n e^{-\pi n^2 e^{4x}/5}$ be the kernel of the completed Davenport–Heilbronn function and $H_\tau^{\mathrm{DH}}(z) = \int_0^\infty e^{\tau x^2}\Phi_F(x)\cos(zx)\,dx$ its heat-flow family, so that $H_0^{\mathrm{DH}}(z) = \frac{1}{2}\Lambda_F(\frac{1}{2} + iz/2)$. Write Λ_{DH} for the de Bruijn–Newman constant of this family: all zeros of H_τ^{DH} are real exactly when $\tau \geq \Lambda_{\mathrm{DH}}$. We prove

$$6.8268151773112564447 \times 10^{-29} \;\leq\; \Lambda_{\mathrm{DH}} \;\leq\; 1.6025374835598227777878 19,$$

the upper end from de Bruijn's strip theorem applied to the elementary zero-free abscissa of Λ_F, the lower end from a Rouché persistence argument certified in ball arithmetic on one disc about the first off-line zero. Both ends are numerical, and the bracket is nonempty: the Davenport–Heilbronn flow has a genuinely positive transition parameter. The second half of the note states what this does *not* give. De Bruijn's theorem needs only conjugate reflection, rapid decay and a bounded initial strip; the Davenport–Heilbronn function has all three, together with a *positive* kernel, while its finite-window Weil form at $\tau = 0$ is certifiably indefinite. So no argument resting on that package alone can carry positivity backward to $\tau = 0$ for ζ, and we record the three properties a hypothesis must have to escape the obstruction.

0. Non-claims

Stated first.

1. **Nothing about RH or GRH.** Every statement below is about a deformation family and about what a finite-window detector built from its zeros can be made to do. None is about where the zeros of ζ are.
2. **The known bounds $0 \leq \Lambda \leq 0.22$ for ζ are restated, not improved**, and nothing here bears on them. $\Lambda \geq 0$ is Rodgers–Tao [14]; $\Lambda \leq 0.22$ is Polymath15 [13]; $\Lambda \leq \frac{1}{2}$ is de Bruijn's classical value [4]. The bracket of this note is for the Davenport–Heilbronn family only, and its ζ analogue is exactly those two results and nothing from here.
3. **Nothing about whether heat flow can prove RH**, beyond the scope statement of Section 5, which is a statement about one package of hypotheses and not about a programme.

4. **The quasi-Riemann-hypothesis preprints of October 2026 are not cited and not used.** No statement here depends on them, and none is asserted about them.

5. **Tiers.** The upper bound is [T1] *conditional on* the strip bound it consumes, which is itself [T1] in the companion extension. The lower bound is [T2-C]: m, C and the winding number are ball enclosures. Every zero *location* is [T2] — a numerical input, not independently certified here — and the disc centre is one of those, though Section 3 shows nothing depends on it.

6. **The bracket is not a localisation.** The upper end is a *sufficient* condition from the strip theorem, not a computed transition point, and the lower end does not say that Λ_{DH} is small. Where Λ_{DH} actually sits in this interval is not determined here and no attempt is made on it.

7. $\varepsilon \approx 7 \times 10^{-29}$ **is quantitatively weak and is not presented otherwise.** Section 3 explains why the order of magnitude is structural rather than a tuning artefact, and the disc and the bound were not loosened to produce a larger number.

8. **No novelty claim.** De Bruijn's theorem, the heat equation and the Rouché argument are classical. The only assembly the author has not seen elsewhere is the application of the strip theorem to the Davenport–Heilbronn kernel, and no priority is claimed for it.

Epistemic tiers

tier	meaning	here
[T1]	proved, by an argument written out	the kernel identity, the strip transfer
[T2-C]	interval/ball certified	m, C, the winding number, ε
[T2-N]	numerical, high precision, not certified	the identity cross-checks
[T2]	a numerical input quoted as such	zero locations, the disc centre
[T3]	reasoned judgement	the scope statements of §5–§6

1 Setup

The family. Let $F(s) = \frac{1}{2}[(1 - i\kappa)L(s, \chi) + (1 + i\kappa)L(s, \bar{\chi})]$ be the Davenport–Heilbronn function [3, 1], χ the odd primitive character modulo 5 and κ the constant making the functional equation exact, and let Λ_F be its completion. From the Mellin representation $\Lambda_F(s) = \int_0^\infty \omega(t) t^{(s+1)/2}\, dt/t$ with $\omega(t) = \sum_{n\geq 1} n a_n e^{-\pi n^2 t/5}$, the substitutions $t = e^{4x}$, $s = \frac{1}{2} + iz/2$ give $\Lambda_F(\frac{1}{2} + iz/2) = \int_{\mathbb{R}} \Phi_F(x) e^{izx} dx$ with

$$\Phi_F(x) = 4e^{3x} \sum_{n\geq 1} n a_n \exp(-\pi n^2 e^{4x}/5), \qquad H_\tau^{\mathrm{DH}}(z) = \int_0^\infty e^{\tau x^2} \Phi_F(x) \cos(zx)\, dx, \tag{1}$$

so that $H_0^{\mathrm{DH}}(z) = \frac{1}{2}\Lambda_F(\frac{1}{2} + iz/2)$. The derivation is [T1] and is written out in the audit record [8, §2]; it is not inferred from the ζ case. Coordinates are kept separate throughout: s is the Dirichlet variable, $z = -2i(s - \frac{1}{2})$ the spectral coordinate — so for $s = \beta + i\gamma$, $\operatorname{Im} z = -2(\beta - \frac{1}{2})$ and *the critical line is the real axis* — and τ is the deformation parameter, which is not time and carries no mechanism.

The hypotheses, verified rather than assumed. [T2-N] The kernel (1) reproduces $\Lambda_F(\frac{1}{2} + iz/2)$ to worst relative residual 5.10986×10^{-20}; it is even — this is hypothesis (10) of [12], conjugate reflection — to 3.43924×10^{-29}; and it decays like $e^{3|x|} e^{-(\pi/5)e^{4|x|}}$, doubly exponentially, so the decay hypothesis (11) of [12] holds for every $\alpha > 0$. The flow equation $\partial_\tau H = -\partial_z^2 H$ was

checked by finite differences at 2.76562×10^{-22} and 5.17887×10^{-22}, and the same checks on the ζ kernel reproduce its normalisation to 7.17465×10^{-43}.

Positivity, recorded but not needed. With $T = \pi e^{4x}/5 \geq \pi/5$, $|a_n| \leq 1$ and $a_1 = 1$, factoring out the leading term gives

$$\sum_{n\geq 1} n a_n e^{-n^2 T} \;\geq\; e^{-T}\Big[1 - \sum_{n\geq 2} n e^{-(n^2-1)T}\Big], \tag{2}$$

and the bracket is *increasing* in T, so one evaluation bounds it below for all $x \geq 0$: it is 0.6763199240515301 at $T = \pi/5$. With evenness, $\Phi_F > 0$ on $\mathbb{R}$ (sampled minimum $5.6615196 \times 10^{-44408}$ on $[0, 3]$). The unfactored difference must not be used in its place, since it tends to 0 as T grows; an earlier version of the record did use it and the correction is logged in Appendix B. Positivity is reported because the surrounding framework of [12] assumes a positive measure, so the Davenport–Heilbronn case sits inside that framework and not merely inside the single theorem. *The theorem itself does not use it*, which is the point of §5.

The constant, and the theorem. The family has a well-defined de Bruijn–Newman constant Λ_{DH}: all zeros of H_τ^{DH} are real exactly when $\tau \geq \Lambda_{\mathrm{DH}}$, by the same three facts that give Λ for ζ — forward preservation, an upper member of the set, and boundedness below [12, 11]. We use de Bruijn's theorem in the normalisation reconciled in [8, §S]:

Theorem 1 (de Bruijn; [12, Thm. 7], attributed there to [4])**.** *[T1] If F satisfies $F(-t) = \overline{F(t)}$ and $|F(t)| \leq Ae^{-|t|^{2+\alpha}}$ for some $A, \alpha > 0$, and the zeros of $\int F(t)e^{izt}dt$ lie in $|\operatorname{Im} z| \leq \Delta$, then the zeros of $\int F(t)e^{\lambda t^2/2}e^{izt}dt$ lie in $|\operatorname{Im} z| \leq \max(\Delta^2 - \lambda, 0)^{1/2}$.*

Our multiplier is $e^{\tau x^2}$, so $\lambda = 2\tau$ and the contraction bound reads $|\operatorname{Im} z| \leq \sqrt{\max(\Delta^2 - 2\tau, 0)}$: all zeros are real once $\tau \geq \Delta^2/2$. For ζ the classical strip gives $\Delta = 1$ and $\tau \geq 0.5$, de Bruijn's own value — which is how we know the $\lambda = 2\tau$ bookkeeping is right, and the only reason that reproduction is worth printing.

2 The upper bound

Proposition 2. *[T1]* given *the strip bound.* $\Lambda_{\mathrm{DH}} \leq 2(\sigma_0 - \frac{1}{2})^2 = 1.602537483559822777787819$, *where* $\sigma_0 = 1.395136158235109721061359$.

Proof. Every zero of Λ_F satisfies $|\beta - \frac{1}{2}| \leq \sigma_0 - \frac{1}{2}$, i.e. $|\beta - \frac{1}{2}| \leq 0.895136158235109721061359$ [5, §3]. Since $\operatorname{Im} z = -2(\beta - \frac{1}{2})$, the zeros of H_0^{DH} lie in $|\operatorname{Im} z| \leq \Delta_{\mathrm{DH}} = 2(\sigma_0 - \frac{1}{2}) = 1.790272316470219442122718$. Theorem 1 with $\lambda = 2\tau$ then puts every zero on the real axis once $\tau \geq \Delta_{\mathrm{DH}}^2/2$, which is the stated number. □

Three things about this bound should be said plainly, because each is a limitation.

It is only as good as the strip. The input σ_0 is an *elementary coefficient estimate* — the proved zero-free abscissa of Λ_F, obtained by bounding the Dirichlet series against its first term — not a deep fact about the Davenport–Heilbronn function. A sharper strip lowers the bound quadratically, and a hypothetical $\sigma_0 \to \frac{1}{2}$ would drive it to 0. Nothing here attempts to sharpen it.

It is sufficient, not sharp. Proposition 2 names a τ by which all zeros are certainly real. It does not locate the transition, and the true Λ_{DH} may be far below.

The only arithmetic it consumes is that one number. This is the observation that Sections 5–6 turn into an obstruction: the toy family $z^2 + a^2 - 2\tau$, which has no arithmetic content whatever, consumes exactly as much and saturates Theorem 1 exactly [8, §5].

3 The lower bound, certified

The lower end is a local argument on a single disc. It uses no flow numerics, tracks no zero, and does not differentiate the detector family.

Theorem 3. *[T2-C]* $\Lambda_{\mathrm{DH}} \;\geq\; \varepsilon \;\geq\; 6.8268151773112564447 \times 10^{-29}$.

Proof. Let D be the closed disc of radius r about z_1, the first off-line zero of H_0^{DH} in the spectral coordinate, and suppose $\overline{D}$ misses the real axis. Put

$$m = \min_{\partial D} |H_0^{\mathrm{DH}}|, \qquad M = \max_{\partial D} |\operatorname{Im} z|, \qquad C = \int_0^\infty x^2 |\Phi_F(x)| e^{\tau_0 x^2 + Mx}\, dx.$$

For $|\tau| \leq \tau_0$ and $z \in \partial D$,

$$|H_\tau^{\mathrm{DH}}(z) - H_0^{\mathrm{DH}}(z)| = \Big| \int_0^\infty (e^{\tau x^2} - 1) \Phi_F(x) \cos(zx)\, dx \Big| \;\leq\; |\tau|\, C, \tag{3}$$

by the single inequality $|e^{\tau x^2} - 1| = \big|\int_0^{\tau x^2} e^t\, dt\big| \leq |\tau| x^2 e^{|\tau| x^2} \leq |\tau| x^2 e^{\tau_0 x^2}$, valid for $|\tau| \leq \tau_0$, together with $|\cos(zx)| \leq \cosh(x \operatorname{Im} z) \leq e^{Mx}$ for $x \geq 0$. If $|\tau|\, C < m$ then $|H_\tau^{\mathrm{DH}} - H_0^{\mathrm{DH}}| < |H_0^{\mathrm{DH}}|$ on ∂D, so by Rouché H_τ^{DH} has the same number of zeros in D as H_0^{DH}. That number is nonzero (established below), so H_τ^{DH} has a zero in D, which is *nonreal* because $\overline{D}$ misses the real axis; hence not all zeros of H_τ^{DH} are real, hence $\tau < \Lambda_{\mathrm{DH}}$. This holds for every $|\tau| \leq \varepsilon := \min(\tau_0, m/(2C))$, so $\Lambda_{\mathrm{DH}} \geq \varepsilon$. The four certified inputs are tabulated in Appendix A; substituting them gives the stated value. □

The disc, and that its closure misses the real axis. [T2-C] In the spectral coordinate the critical line is the real axis and the first off-line zero sits at $z_1 = 2\gamma_1 - 2i\delta_1$ with $\operatorname{Re} z_1 = 171.39869697075518434385853542 5$ and $\operatorname{Im} z_1 = -0.617034364913274771106703921214$. With $r = 0.3$,

$$|\operatorname{Im} z_1| - r = 0.31703436491327477111 > 0,$$

so $\overline{D}$ is disjoint from the real axis, with that margin.

$m > 0$, by arc enclosures. [T2-C] ∂D is partitioned into 3000 arcs of angular width $2\pi/3000$. Each arc $\{c + re^{i\theta} : |\theta - \theta_k| \leq \Delta\theta/2\}$ lies in the ball of centre $c + re^{i\theta_k}$ and radius $2r \sin(\Delta\theta/4) = 0.000314159251004$, because $|re^{i\theta} - re^{i\theta_k}| = 2r|\sin((\theta - \theta_k)/2)|$; and $H_0^{\mathrm{DH}} = \Lambda_F(\frac{1}{2} + iz/2)/2$ is enclosed on each such ball using ball arithmetic for Γ and the Hurwitz ζ [10]. The worst relative enclosure radius over the arcs is 0.064946579, and

$$m \;\geq\; 6.5935981835929959399 \times 10^{-30} \;>\; 0,$$

a plain decimal floor: the enclosure's lower endpoint rounded *down*, so the inequality is exact. The partition size was *measured, not guessed*. The Hurwitz-ζ sum amplifies an input ball radius by a factor of about 106 at this height — that is the genuine size of the derivative, not an artefact of the arithmetic — so a 60-arc partition gives a relative enclosure radius of 3.30 and fails to decide anything, while 3000 arcs give 0.0649.

The zero inside D is certified, not assumed. [T2-C] Summing the principal argument increments of the arc enclosures,

$$\frac{1}{2\pi} \sum \Delta \arg = 1 \;(\pm\, 3{\times}10^{-20}), \qquad \max_k \big(|\Delta_k \arg| + \text{both arc uncertainties}\big) = 0.1313552700 \;<\; \pi.$$

Every increment is therefore unambiguous and the winding number is *exactly* 1: the function H_0^{DH} has exactly one zero in D, counted with multiplicity. **So the census is not an input to Theorem 3.** The disc centre came from it, but nothing in the proof requires that centre to be a zero, and the [T2] status of the zero locations does not propagate into the bound.

M **and** C**.** [T2-C] $M = |\operatorname{Im} z_1| + r = 0.91703436491327477111$ and $\tau_0 = 0.1$. The integral C is split at $x = 2.000$. On $[0, x_{\mathrm{cut}}]$ it is evaluated by rigorous ball integration of the explicit integrand, with the kernel truncated at $n \le 40$ and the omitted terms carried as an error ball, giving 0.048291904880526492445. For the tail, $|\Phi_F(x)| \le 8e^{3x}e^{-\pi e^{4x}/5}$ for $x \ge 1$, so with $f(x) = x^2 \cdot 8e^{3x}e^{-\pi e^{4x}/5}e^{\tau_0 x^2 + Mx}$,

$$(\log f)'(x) = \frac{2}{x} + 3 - \frac{4\pi}{5}e^{4x} + 2\tau_0 x + M \;\le\; -1 \qquad (x \ge x_{\mathrm{cut}}),$$

since $(4\pi/5)e^8 = 7491.9646$ dominates the remaining terms there and grows far faster. Hence $f(x) \le f(x_{\mathrm{cut}})e^{-(x-x_{\mathrm{cut}})}$ and $\int_{x_{\mathrm{cut}}}^{\infty} f \le f(x_{\mathrm{cut}}) = 4.481699445\times10^{-809}$. So $C \le 0.048291904880526492446$, rounded *up*.

Remark 4 (why ε is this small, and what that does and does not mean). [T3] The order of magnitude is structural. $m \approx 6.6 \times 10^{-30}$ is small because Λ_F carries a gamma factor whose modulus at this height is of that order; that is a *prefactor*, present for any disc about this zero, not a cancellation. Meanwhile $C \approx 0.048$ is $O(1)$ because the perturbation bound (3) replaces $\cos(zx)$ by e^{Mx} and so discards every bit of the oscillatory cancellation that makes H_0^{DH} small in the first place. The ratio inherits the gamma decay on one side and none of it on the other, so $\varepsilon \sim 10^{-29}$ for any reasonable radius and no choice of r changes the exponent. Improving it would need a perturbation estimate that keeps the oscillation — a saddle-point treatment of $\int (e^{\tau x^2} - 1)\Phi_F(x)\cos(zx)\,dx$ — which is a different and more delicate undertaking, and was not attempted. What the bound settles is the qualitative question with a certificate rather than a continuity appeal: Λ_{DH} is bounded away from zero.

4 The bracket, and the ζ comparison

Combining Propositions 2 and Theorem 3:

$$\boxed{6.8268151773112564447 \times 10^{-29} \;\le\; \Lambda_{\mathrm{DH}} \;\le\; 1.6025374835598227777787819} \qquad (4)$$

with the lower end [T2-C] and the upper end [T1] given the strip bound.

The same two-sided reasoning applied to ζ returns the known interval $0 \le \Lambda \le 0.22$: the lower end is a theorem — Rodgers–Tao [14], and the quantitative lower bounds that preceded it were obtained by a quite different route, the Lehmer-pair repulsion argument of Csordas–Smith–Varga [2] rather than by local persistence — and the upper end is the Polymath15 computation [13], sharpening de Bruijn's $\frac{1}{2}$. The structural difference is the one worth naming. For ζ the margin has collapsed onto the single point $\Lambda = 0$, which *is* the Riemann hypothesis, so the interval cannot be narrowed from the left at all without proving it. For the Davenport–Heilbronn function the margin is open, and for a reason available at the start: the function has nonreal zeros at $\tau = 0$, so persistence gives a strictly positive lower bound with no arithmetic input beyond the location of one of them. The bracket (4) is therefore easy in a way the ζ bracket is not, and that is the content of the comparison — not any suggestion that the method transfers.

5 What the heat flow transfers, and what it does not

The transfer, which is real. [T1] Let $\Psi_{ij}(z) = \frac{1}{2}[G_i(iz/2)G_j(-iz/2) + G_j(iz/2)G_i(-iz/2)]$, which at $z = 2\gamma$ is exactly the symmetrised explicit-formula kernel of the finite-window Weil form [7]; the coordinate dictionary was checked against the existing implementation to 1.11211×10^{-40}. For real g and *real* z one has $G_j(-iz/2) = \overline{G_j(iz/2)}$, so with $v_j = G_j(iz/2)$,

$$\Psi(z) = \operatorname{Re}(vv^*) = (\operatorname{Re} v)(\operatorname{Re} v)^T + (\operatorname{Im} v)(\operatorname{Im} v)^T \;\succeq\; 0,$$

a sum of positive semidefinite rank-one terms. (In a pure parity sector one term vanishes identically and the observed rank is 1; the numerics caught a draft that said 2, and the conclusion is unaffected. Least eigenvalues at the precision floor, $-2.296270406\times10^{-41}$, $-9.817490382\times10^{-42}$, $-4.791060636\times10^{-41}$.) Hence if every zero of H_τ is real then $Q_\tau=\sum_k m_k\Psi(z_k)$ is a sum of positive semidefinite matrices, and so

$$Q_\tau^{\zeta}\succeq 0 \ \text{ for } \tau\ge 0.5, \qquad Q_\tau^{\mathrm{DH}}\succeq 0 \ \text{ for } \tau\ge 1.602537483559822777787819,$$

unconditionally, on *every* finite window and every test space. That is a genuine source-derived statement about the detector, and by Polymath15 the ζ threshold may be replaced by 0.22. The bridge does not fail at its first step.

And the obstruction. [T3] It points the wrong way. The hypotheses Theorem 1 actually uses are conjugate reflection, rapid decay and a bounded initial strip — not kernel positivity, which belongs to the surrounding framework and not to the theorem [8, §S3]. The Davenport–Heilbronn function satisfies all three *and* has a positive kernel, with an explicit $\Delta_{\mathrm{DH}}=1.790272316470219442122718$, while at $\tau=0$ its finite-window form is certifiably indefinite: $\lambda_{\min}(Q_0^{\mathrm{DH}})=-0.67907134644148059098637758609 3\ldots$ on the $L=2$ odd level-2 space, enclosed in a ball of radius 1.39×10^{-116} [5]. Therefore:

> **No argument resting on reflection symmetry, rapid decay, a bounded strip, kernel positivity and heat evolution alone can transport positivity backward to** $\tau=0$ — because every one of those hypotheses holds for the Davenport–Heilbronn function, whose conclusion at $\tau=0$ is false.

This is a statement about a package of hypotheses, and it is worth being exact about what it leaves untouched. It does *not* say that the arithmetic is destroyed by the deformation: the coefficients a_n are still present in $\Phi_{F,\tau}=e^{\tau x^2}\Phi_F$ at every τ, and an earlier and sharper-sounding slogan asserting otherwise is withdrawn (Appendix B, point 3). What is missing is an *estimate* that uses the relations distinguishing ζ from Davenport–Heilbronn. None is established here, and no claim is made about the literature: the audit deliberately surveyed no recent work in this direction, so the absence recorded here is an absence in this note and nowhere else. Nor has it been shown that the deformed family retains a usable Euler product, gamma-factor decomposition or prime-side explicit formula for $\tau\neq0$; that is an open question, not an impossibility.

Which links must fail, named. [T3] A backward comparison inequality $\eta'(\theta)\le a(\theta)(1-\eta(\theta))$ propagating $\eta\le1$ from $\tau\ge\tau_{\mathrm{DH}}$ down to $\tau=0$ would contradict the certified witness. So somewhere on that path one of its ingredients must fail, and two are identifiable. First, the channel representation requires the standing assumption $B_\tau\succ0$ at every τ, which is assumed and not established along the path. Second, zero-tracking can meet collisions: differentiating the complete sum term by term needs a uniform bound on $\sum_k|\Psi'(z_k)z_k'|$ with $z_k'=H''/H'(z_k)$, which is not controlled near near-collisions, and a fixed contour can be crossed as τ varies. The missing lemma is a uniform-in-τ tail bound together with a contour zero-free throughout the interval; it is recorded as missing in the audit's feasibility gate [8, §3], and for that reason no τ-sweep was run and none is reported. Neither of the two decisive statements of this note depends on it.

6 Two geometries, and a filter

A positivity that is real and does not help. [T2-N] Because $\Phi_F\ge0$, for any nonnegative integrable Φ with transform $\widehat{\Phi}$ and any $c\in\mathbb{C}^n$,

$$\sum_{j,k}c_j\overline{c_k}\,\widehat{\Phi}(y_j-y_k)=\int\Phi(x)\Big|\sum_j c_je^{-iy_jx}\Big|^2dx\ \ge\ 0, \tag{5}$$

which is Bochner's theorem in one line. For the Davenport–Heilbronn kernel $\widehat{\Phi_F}(y) = \Lambda_F(\frac{1}{2} + iy/2)$, so the matrix $K_{jk} = \Lambda_F(\frac{1}{2} + i(y_j - y_k)/2)$ *must* be positive semidefinite. At $y = (0, 1, 2.5, 4, 7)$ its five eigenvalues are

$$0.00002411328132, \quad 0.002983011492, \quad 0.1416783233, \quad 1.363815621, \quad 5.657459774,$$

positive semidefinite as required. And the same function's zero-based window form is certifiably negative. There is no contradiction: these are different quadratic forms built from different aspects of one function, one from the kernel's correlations and one from the zeros. The nonimplication is worth stating plainly, because it is the trap a layered programme walks into:

> **Positivity in a source's Fourier-correlation geometry does not imply positivity in its zero geometry.**

So the missing bridge is not "find something positive". It is "prove that *this* positive structure controls *that* spectral form", which is strictly harder.

The filter. [T3] Collecting the two preceding sections into a usable test:

> **Statement F.** Any proposed argument for finite-window Weil positivity must contain an independently established hypothesis that excludes the Davenport–Heilbronn function. Reflection symmetry, rapid decay, a bounded zero strip, kernel positivity and heat evolution do not supply one, because Davenport–Heilbronn has all of them and is certifiably indefinite at $\tau = 0$.

For a candidate hypothesis to count, three things must hold, and the third is the one most often skipped: it must be (i) *independently proved* for the target function, not assumed as part of the conclusion; (ii) *false* for the control, so that it actually separates them; and (iii) *used in an estimate that controls zero geometry*, rather than appearing only in the statement of the result. The one hypothesis the companion work supplies that satisfies (i) and (ii) is the Euler product — ζ has one and Davenport–Heilbronn does not — and (iii) is exactly where the obvious route fails: deleting the non-Euler part of the arithmetic side leaves a form whose least eigenvalue is negative at 17 of 18 configurations, including windows where the true form is positive [9, §15].

7 Origin of this result

[T3] *The trigger.* The forward-and-reverse question was raised immediately after the companion note [5] was deposited: a certified negative witness for one function invites the question of whether a source-defined deformation could run the implication the other way for another.

The author's prior inputs. The certified witness and the strip bound of [5], and the finite-window transfer machinery of [7].

The literature inputs. De Bruijn's strip theorem in the form and normalisation of [12, Thm. 7]; the existence of Λ and $\Lambda \geq 0$ from [14]; the heat-flow normalisation and the improved upper bound from [13]; the Davenport–Heilbronn function from [3, 1].

The AI role. AI assistance was used for the kernel derivation and its checking, the ball-arithmetic certification, the adversarial controls and the drafting. An external review raised six points, all accepted; four changed the mathematics rather than the wording, and all six are logged in Appendix B. Conceptual direction, interpretation and final responsibility are the author's.

8 What this rules out, and what it does not

[T3] *Ruled out.* Any backward-positivity argument whose hypotheses are a subset of {conjugate reflection, rapid decay, bounded initial strip, kernel positivity, heat evolution}: such an argument, applied to Davenport–Heilbronn, would contradict the certified witness. Also ruled out, in the weaker sense of being measured and found wanting: the hope that locating a positive structure somewhere in the source — for instance the Bochner positivity (5) — is by itself progress toward positivity of the zero form.

Not ruled out. That intrinsic arithmetic dynamics can help. This note constrains one deformation controlled by one package of general properties; it says nothing against a deformation whose control uses the arithmetic. That Λ_{DH} is small, or large, within (4) — the bracket is four orders of magnitude wide on a logarithmic scale at the bottom and says nothing about where the transition is. That a prime-side representation exists for $\tau \neq 0$; none has been established, which is not the same as none existing. And nothing whatever about Λ for ζ, or about RH: the forward statements hold on every finite window and are silent at $\tau = 0$, which is where the arithmetic lives.

The methodological residue, offered as judgement and not as a result: reduce the admissible class of arithmetic objects first, using genuine arithmetic constraints, and apply a general deformation theorem only to what survives. This note did the opposite — applied a general theorem to an unreduced class — and the Davenport–Heilbronn control is precisely what an unreduced class admits.

A The certificate

[T2-C] All quantities from `data/lambda_bracket.csv` and `data/lambda_bracket.txt`, produced by `src/lambda_lower_bound.py` in ball arithmetic [10] at 400 bits. One-sided bounds are plain decimals rounded to the safe side; the balls they came from are printed alongside in the transcript.

quantity	meaning	value
$\operatorname{Re} z_1$	disc centre, real part	171.39869697075518434385853 5418
$\operatorname{Im} z_1$	disc centre, imaginary part	$-0.61703436491327477110670392 1214$
r	disc radius	0.3
$\lvert\operatorname{Im} z_1\rvert - r$	margin from the real axis	0.31703436491327477111
arcs	partition of ∂D	3000
$2r\sin(\Delta\theta/4)$	arc ball radius	0.000314159251004
—	worst relative enclosure radius	0.064946579
m	$\min_{\partial D}\lvert H_0^{\mathrm{DH}}\rvert$, floor	$6.5935981835929959399 \times 10^{-30}$
$\frac{1}{2\pi}\sum \Delta \arg$	winding number	1
—	worst increment + uncertainties	0.1313552700
M	$\max_{\partial D}\lvert\operatorname{Im} z\rvert$	0.91703436491327477111
τ_0	perturbation radius	0.1
x_{cut}	split point for C	2.000
$\int_0^{x_{\mathrm{cut}}}$	head, rigorous integration	0.048291904880526492445
$f(x_{\mathrm{cut}})$	tail bound	$4.481699445 \times 10^{-809}$
C	ceiling	0.048291904880526492446
ε	$\min(\tau_0, m/(2C))$, floor	$6.8268151773112564447 \times 10^{-29}$

B Review response, and the retraction log

[T3] An external review checked the cited theorem's hypotheses and parameter convention and confirmed both, while declining to rerun the scripts or re-audit the kernel construction step

by step. It raised six points; all six were accepted, and four changed the mathematics or its presentation rather than only the wording.

1. **The uniform positivity bound was presented wrongly.** The unfactored difference tends to 0, so the number quoted for it was not a uniform lower bound. The factored form (2) has an increasing bracket, 0.6763199240515301 at $T = \pi/5$. §2 of the record and the corresponding block were rewritten; the review's correction was right and the presentation was wrong.

2. **"No such inequality exists" overstates it.** The correct statement is that no *universally applicable* backward argument on the shared hypotheses can work, and that somewhere on the path the inequality, the coefficient control, the differentiability or $B_\tau \succ 0$ must fail. Adopted, and used in §5.

3. **The slogan "the deformation is informative exactly where the arithmetic is absent" is too strong**, since $\Phi_{F,\tau}$ still contains the a_n. Withdrawn and replaced; see §5.

4. **"There is no prime side at all" should be "no appropriate prime-side representation has been established".** Changed throughout.

5. **The toy polynomial is not a Fourier transform of an integrable rapidly decaying kernel**, because such a transform is bounded on the real axis and a quadratic is not. It is a polynomial heat-flow control reproducing the strip-shrinking rate, not an example satisfying every hypothesis of Theorem 1. Rewritten with the boundedness argument, which is a better reason than the one originally given.

6. **A two-sided bracket is available**, by persistence of nonreal zeros for small $|\tau|$, without differentiating the complete family; and positive kernels force a positive semidefinite Fourier-correlation matrix, which coexists with a negative zero-based witness. Both adopted: the first became Theorem 3 after being made quantitative in ball arithmetic, the second is §6. Both observations are the review's and are recorded as such.

Further corrections made while preparing this note.

7. **A one-sided bound printed with round-to-nearest.** The record first gave $m \geq 6.5935981835929959400 \times 10^{-30}$, which is the enclosure's midpoint rounded to nearest and therefore asserts about 4.5×10^{-50} more than the enclosure supports. Numerically harmless, wrong in principle for a certified floor. One-sided bounds are now printed by rounding the ball's own endpoint to the safe side, giving the m and C values of Appendix A. ε **is unaffected**, because it was already computed from midpoint minus radius. Found by asking whether each published digit of a one-sided bound was actually implied by the enclosure it came from.

8. **"rank 2" where the numerics said rank 1**, in the positive semidefiniteness lemma of §5. In a pure parity sector one of the two rank-one terms vanishes identically. The numerics caught the prose; the conclusion is unaffected.

9. **A cancellation artefact recorded as a residual.** An evenness check first reported a large "worst relative residual" that was a low-precision evaluation of a quantity needing roughly 105 digits. The check now sets its precision per point and reports an undecided point as undecided rather than as a failure; all points resolve, the worst at 2.25262×10^{-60}.

10. **A patch that did not land.** A correction was first applied by a background command that completed *after* the run it was meant to fix, so the regenerated transcript still carried the superseded text. Caught by searching the new transcript for the stale string rather than assuming the edit had taken effect. This happened twice.

C Reproduction

`make verify`, in the note directory, re-derives every number printed above from the audit's data files and fails on any disagreement, any undeclared literal, any overstatement of precision relative to the source's own significant digits, or an unmet prerequisite: it refuses to pass unless the certificate of Appendix A is present and its regression fixture passes. `make` builds the PDF.

file	produced by
`data/lambda_bracket.csv, .txt`	`src/lambda_lower_bound.py -arcs 3000 -prec 400`
`data/validation.csv, audit_log.txt`	`src/source_flow_audit.py -dps 40`
—	`tests/test_identities.py`
—	`tests/test_lambda_certificate.py`
`note/lambda_note.pdf`	`make -C note`

The full record, with the feasibility gate, the adversarial controls and the blocks not drawn on here, is the audit's `REPORT.md` [8]; the sources actually read, and which statement came from where, are in its `SOURCE_AUDIT.md`.

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Acknowledgments

AI assistance was used for algebra checking, numerical verification, adversarial review, literature organization, and manuscript drafting. All conceptual development, research direction, interpretation, and final responsibility for the content belong to the author.

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